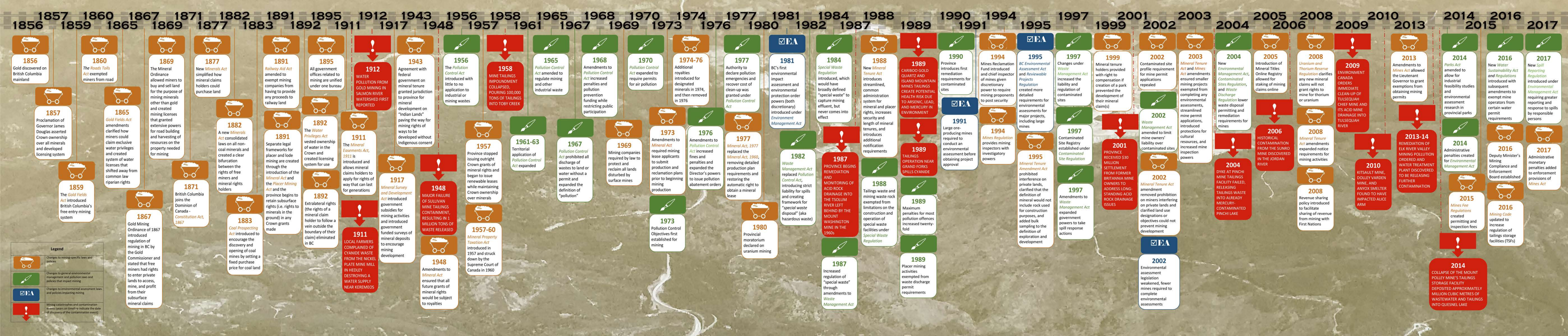




DIGGING UP A LEGISLATIVE HISTORY MINING LAW IN BRITISH COLUMBIA 1856-2017

One day of student research: 160 years of history

For over 160 years, mining activity has impacted British Columbia's environment. This timeline was developed to show how colonial laws related to mining in BC have evolved, or stayed the same. It does not capture every legislative change or every major mining contamination event in BC, but it does provide an overview of the major changes in legislation. Its structure tells a factual and readable story for anyone interested in the changing nature of regulatory oversight of the mining sector in British Columbia.

Law students from the University of Victoria, University of British Columbia, and Thompson Rivers University provided a large portion of the information in this timeline through their participation in a "Research-a-thon" on Feb 2, 2018, organized by the Environmental Law Club and Environmental Law Centre at the University of Victoria. Environmental Law Club members compiled and edited the 2018 Research-a-thon results into a comprehensive report, which provided the content for this timeline representation.

As an introductory tool for understanding the many twists and turns in BC's legislative history related to mining, this timeline may also reveal opportunities to improve how the province's mining industry is regulated in order to ensure the air, water, and land that we share can remain healthy for future generations.

Legend

- Changes to mining-specific laws and policies
- Changes to general environmental management and pollution laws and policies that impact mining
- Changes to environmental assessment laws and policies impacting mining
- Mining catastrophes and contamination events (years on timeline indicate the date of discovery of the contamination event)